

FOUR SALONS · FOUR YEARS · EVERY VISIT, EVERY SALE

Your registers already knew. *Here is what they said.*

Thirteen findings from your own till log. Each one is a sentence you can say out loud, a number you can check, and something to do about it on Monday.

4	194,672	11,411	\$2.09M	2016-2020
SALONS	VISITS	CUSTOMERS	THROUGH THE REGISTER	EVERY DAY OF IT

Everything here came out of those files and nowhere else. Nothing is estimated, benchmarked or imported. Every figure opens — tap **“Show me the numbers”** under any finding and you get the counts, the cohort and the caveat. And at the end is the list of good-sounding ideas we tested and killed, including two of our own.

IF YOU READ NOTHING ELSE

The whole business in four numbers

Every finding below hangs off these.

28% → 87%

The first renewal is the only hard one.

Fewer than three in ten members renew their first month. By the tenth, nearly nine in ten do — and it keeps climbing. All of your membership loss is on the bottom step.

\$69 a year

What a member out-earns a casual customer. \$154 against \$85, in the one

full clean year. Members are a third of your customers and more than half of your money.

Zero

What price has to do with renewal.

Your \$30 plans and your \$140 plans renew at the same rate. Discounting is not a lever here. Usage is — and it is a steep one.

4 lists

The entire playbook. Day 5 for first-timers. Day 15 for quiet members. Expiry plus 7 for lapsed ones. Ninety-days-quiet for comebacks. Your own till can print all four.

Four calendars and no discounts. Not one finding in this report asks you to cut a price. Every one of them asks you to talk to a specific, nameable list of people on a specific day — because that is what your data says actually moves.

№ 1 • MEMBERSHIPS

Nobody renews a membership
they didn't use

15% → 54% first-month renewal, sorted only by
how often they came in

Members who barely used their first month renew **one time in seven**. Members who used it hard renew **better than one in two**. That is not a small tilt — it is more than a three-fold swing, and it holds in **all four of your salons**.

And it has *nothing to do with the price*. Cheap plans, mid plans, expensive plans — they renew within a few points of each other, with no pattern at all. The member you don't see is the member you lose, and no discount buys them back.

You can see it coming by mid-month. **By the 15th you can pull the one member in four you've barely seen — three-quarters of them won't renew, against two-thirds of everyone else.**

3.5x swing across usage

price bands: 32.1 • 32.8 • 27.7 • 35.2% — no gradient

Monday: pull every member past day 15 of their month with fewer than four visits. Invite them **in** — a session reminder, a “your month is half gone” nudge. Not money off. Bask builds that list on the 15th of every month, by itself.

The \$9 sachet is not a sample. It's a dead end.

14% vs 55% odds the next lotion is a bottle — sachet-first buyer vs bottle-first buyer

Seven in ten of your lotion customers buy a sachet first. Take the ones who come back and buy lotion a second time — the bottle-first customer moves to another bottle **54.6%** of the time. The sachet-first customer moves up **14.1%** of the time. Same shelf, same staff, same second purchase. Four times the difference.

They are not sampling their way up. They are settling in — and paying **\$19.00 an ounce** to do it, when the bottle on the same shelf is **\$4.53 an ounce**. Your most frequent lotion buyers are your worst-served lotion buyers.

Nobody graduates without being asked.

sachet \$19.00/oz • bottle \$4.53/oz

69.6% of lotion customers start on a sachet

only 15% ever buy a bottle

Monday: the moment someone reaches for a **second** sachet, say the sentence — “two of these cost more than half the bottle.” That moment walks up to your register on its own, roughly every other sachet customer. **For UVALUX:** this is what a sampling programme should be measured on — sachet-to-bottle conversion, per account, per quarter. Right now the sample is the product.

When a month runs out you have fourteen days. Then a cliff.

14 days flat for two weeks — then renew-again odds fall off

A member who buys their next month **inside two weeks** stays on the member path: better than half of them renew again after that. It makes no difference whether they buy on the day it expired or on day thirteen — **the odds are flat across the whole fortnight**.

Past day fourteen it drops. Fifteen to thirty days out, renew-again falls to **40%**. Past a month, **33%**. That is not a gentle decay — it is a plateau and then a step. *You have a deadline, and it is fourteen days long.*

inside 14 days: ~53% renew again

after 30 days: 33%

Monday: put every expired member on a fourteen-day clock, and make the touch land at **expiry + 7** — “your month ran out last week, want to keep going?” Month-end is too late; that is the wrong side of the cliff. Bask runs the expiry calendar and counts the days down for you.

If they don't join on the first two visits, they never join

76.8% of everyone who ever became a member joined on visit one

87% joined by visit two. Everything after that is a rounding error spread across four years.

Here is the part nobody would guess. A regular on their **twelfth** un-membered visit is **no more likely to join than someone on their second**. Not slightly less likely — *the same*, at every single step from one to twelve. Loyalty does not ripen into membership here. The moment is at the beginning or it never happens.

visit 1: 76.8% • by visit 2: 87.2% • by visit 5: 92.3%

visit 12 converts no better than visit 2

Monday: move the membership conversation onto **visits one and two**, and put your best closer there. Then stop re-pitching your long-time regulars — they have already answered. Sell them a different thing: a punch card, a loyalty rate, a bundle. The monthly close is not going to land on the twelfth ask either.

A first-timer decides in a week,
not a month

61% → 27% odds a first-timer ever comes back —
overall, then after seven silent days

Six in ten first-timers come back within six months. But if a week goes by with no second visit, that collapses to **fewer than three in ten** — and it keeps falling fast: **two in ten** after fourteen days, **one in seven** after a month, **one in twenty** after ninety days.

Which means the month-end follow-up everyone runs is a conversation with people who already decided no. *The decision is made in week one. Be there in week one.*

~320 undecided first-timers per salon each year

a rescued late returner spends \$94.08 in year one

Monday: one message on **day 5** to every first-timer who hasn't come back — "we'd love to see you again." Bask prints that list daily; it is never more than a handful of names. Each percentage point of that pool you convert is worth about **\$293 a year per salon** — sized from what those customers actually went on to spend, not a promise that the text works.

You cannot feel them leaving.
You can only count the days.

\$93 vs \$63 a name on your win-back list vs an
unknown walk-in, next twelve months

Everyone believes customers slow down before they quit. Yours don't. We took every regular who disappeared and looked at their last three visits: they came in on **the same rhythm as the people who stayed**. There is no wobble, no warning, no tell. An alert watching for "they're slowing down" is wrong nine times out of ten.

So the only trigger that works is the calendar — and the calendar is *good*. You can't know which walk-in will come back. You *can* know that a name on your ninety-days-quiet list is worth about **\$93 over the next year**, where an unknown new face averages **\$63**. Same effort, known target, better odds.

One thing to be honest about: this is a cycle. About **62%** of the people you win back go quiet again. That is not a failure — it is a reason to run the list every month instead of once.

"they're slowing down" alerts: 8.7% right

a known name beats an unknown one by ~50%

Monday: run the **ninety-days-quiet list**, every month, forever. And split it by how long they'd been coming — the ones you lost were mostly **burst tanners** on a run (they were coming in every three days, not every five), so the message that reaches a two-year regular is not the message that reaches them.

The comeback visit closes memberships better than any other visit

28.7% of comeback visits end with a membership sold that same day

Nearly three in ten. That is **two and a half times** the rate of a comparable ordinary visit — comparing like with like, against customers who could actually have started a membership that day.

The person walking back through your door after months away is not a retention problem. *They are the warmest buyer in the building* — someone who already decided, on their own, that they wanted to tan again. Treat that visit like a first visit and it converts like one.

2.5× the membership close of a comparable visit

Monday: script the comeback. Greet them by name, walk them round what's changed, offer the join — the same routine your best closer runs on a first visit. Which means the win-back list from № 6 is not a retention cost. It is the highest-converting sales audience you have, and you can print it.

A quarter of your money shops at more than one of your stores

\$533,585

25.5% of all revenue, from customers who use more than one location

One customer in nine has been to more than one of your four salons. That group is **a quarter of all your revenue** and **30% of all your visits**. Tighten it right down — count only people with three or more visits at a second store, no accidental drop-ins — and it is *still* **17% of everything you take**.

Your best customers do not experience four businesses. They experience one, and they move around inside it. Anything that makes the four look different to them — a membership that doesn't travel, a lotion that's only on one shelf, a price that changes across town — is friction you are charging your heaviest spenders.

11.5% of customers → 25.5% of revenue

and 11.5% is a floor, not a ceiling

Monday: make the four stores behave like one for the people who already treat them that way — memberships honoured everywhere, the same lotion on every shelf, the same price on the wall. **For UVALUX:** stock and sell this group as **one market, not four accounts**. A gap on one location's shelf leaks the whole group's best baskets, and per-store numbers will never show you why.

The first renewal is the only hard one

28% → 87% renewal odds, first cycle to fifteenth

Fewer than three members in ten renew their first month. Then it climbs, almost every single cycle: **39%, 47%, 54%, 59%** ... and by the tenth month **nearly eight in ten**, on up to **87%**.

Every renewal you win compounds — **the next one is 20 to 45% more likely** than the one before. A member on their tenth month is a different animal from a member on their first, and they got there one save at a time.

Which tells you exactly where to spend: *all of the mortality is on the bottom step*. Findings № 1, 3 and 4 all operate on that step, and nothing else in this document matters as much.

members: 33.7% of customers, 56.0% of revenue

members out-earn casuals by \$69/yr

Monday: stop spreading your attention evenly across members. Every save you make in **month one** is worth several months of a mature member's attention, because the escalator does the rest of the work for free. Bask can show you the cycle number next to every member's name — that one column reorders your whole day.

Autumn first-timers are your best ones — and you lose most of them at the door

+21% what an autumn first-timer is worth against a spring one — if you keep them

A first-timer who walks in during **September to November** comes back **57%** of the time. One who walks in during spring, **69%**. You lose the autumn recruit far more often.

But the ones you keep are *better*. An autumn first-timer who sticks is worth **\$108.69** in their first year against a spring one's **\$89.80** — about a fifth more. Fewest recruits, hardest to hold, worth the most: that is the definition of where the follow-up should go first.

autumn 57% return vs spring 69%

\$108.69 vs \$89.80 when kept

Monday: point the day-5 message (№ 5) and your best first-visit person at the **September-November** walk-ins before anyone else. They arrive in exactly the months when new faces are scarcest, and they are the ones worth chasing hardest.

January members stay. July members are borrowing a tan.

1.75×

a January joiner's renewal odds
against a July joiner's, year for year

A member who signs up in **January renews at 38.7%** — against 27% for every other month of the year. A member who signs up in **July** renews at barely half the January rate. They came for a fortnight in the sun and they meant it.

And this is *specifically January*, not “winter”. December and February members look like everybody else. Resolution season is a real thing and it shows up in your renewal book.

January 38.7% vs 27% all other months

“winter is better” is false — it's January only

Monday (well, in December): put your recruitment push where the good members are — the first three weeks of January. And for the July joiner, stop banking on a renewal that four times in five will not come: sell them the **bigger upfront package** instead. **For UVALUX:** January sell-in support belongs next to the March inventory ramp.

313 pairs of your customers always arrive together

50×

how far above chance these pairings
are — 313 pairs, 554 named
customers

Not “sometimes overlap”. **554 customers** who show up in the same minute as the same other person, over and over, for years. We tried hard to make this go away — reshuffling everyone’s visits at random, thousands of times, keeping each person’s exact visit count. Chance produces **five** such pairs. Your salons have **313**.

These are real relationships, and they are sitting in your till log with names attached. *You can build a product for them tomorrow.*

313 stable pairs • 554 customers

what we are NOT claiming: that pairs quit together — see below

Monday: sell the **duo**. A two-person membership, a bring-your-person week, a referral that names the actual person they already come with. Bask can list every stable pair in your book from the check-in log alone — no survey, no app, no asking anyone anything.

Renewal day is the quietest register in the shop

560

renewal moments per salon per year
— every one of them on your
calendar in advance

The day a member hands you money for another month is the day you are **least likely to sell them anything else**. Renewal transactions attach a retail item **7.7%** of the time against **11.7%** on other service transactions — a 26% shortfall that survives controlling for veteran customers, who buy less anyway.

Compare that to a *signup* day, where nearly one transaction in five goes out with lotion. Same commitment, same counter — the difference is that a signup gets a conversation and a renewal gets a receipt.

The dollars here are small and we will say so. What is not small is that these are **560 moments a year you know about in advance**. There is no cheaper prompt in the building.

renewal day 7.7% • other days 11.7% • signup day 19.2%

worth a few hundred dollars a salon-year — not a windfall

Monday: one line at the register on every renewal — “want the bottle on the package?” Bask can fire the prompt automatically, because the renewal date was already sitting in the system. Do not budget for this one; just stop leaving it on the floor.

Things we checked so you don't have to

Every idea below sounds true. Several of them were *ours* — findings from our own first pass that we then set out to destroy, and did. Knowing what doesn't hold is how you avoid spending Monday on it, and it is the only reason to trust the thirteen that did.

× **"A won-back customer is worth more than a new one."**

We wrote that. Then we checked it, and it fell apart. A reactivated customer earns about \$93 over the next year — but a new customer who came back even *once* earns \$92, and one with eight visits earns \$158. The "premium" was arithmetic: winning someone back requires two visits by definition, while the new-customer average is dragged down by everyone who never returned. Worse, the same reactivated customers earned **\$108 in the year before they lapsed** — more than the \$93 after. Winning someone back is partial recovery of a customer you already had. It is not an upgrade on a new one.

WHAT SURVIVES IS THE TARGETING ARGUMENT — FINDING № 6

× **"Lose one, lose two — when half a pair quits, the other follows."**

Also ours, also dead. Survivors did drop 47% after their partner stopped coming — which looked damning until we asked what a comparable customer does over the same stretch of calendar with no partner leaving at all. They drop **49.5%**. The survivors declined *less* than chance. There is no contagion here; there is a population of customers that fades, and pairs fade with it. The pairs themselves are real (№ 12). The domino effect is not, and we are not going to sell you a flag built on it.

SELL THE PAIRS. DON'T SELL THE CONTAGION.

× **"Customers slow down before they quit."**

No. Departing regulars' final visits are indistinguishable from their normal ones. An alert watching for stretching intervals is right 8.7% of the time. That is precisely why № 6 runs on a calendar instead of on instinct.

× **“Harvest new customers fast — the value is up front.”**

No. A customer pays like an annuity: only 12.5% of a two-year customer's revenue arrives in the first 30 days, 26% by day 90, 62.6% by day 365. Every finding here is a retention calendar, and that is not a style choice — it is what the money does.

× **“Cheaper packages renew better.”**

No. From your \$30 plans to your \$140 plans, renewal moves within a few points and in no particular direction. Four separate attempts to find a hidden price effect all failed. This is why not one recommendation in this document is a discount.

× **“A fifth of your visits walk in as pairs.”**

Our own number, and it doesn't stand. Once you account for how busy your salons are, the rate of two people arriving within three minutes of each other is *below* what random chance produces. Busy shops make coincidental neighbours. The finding lives in the *repeat* pairings (№ 12), not the headline count.

× **“Your beds run nearly empty, so every extra visit is pure profit.”**

We could not check this and we will not repeat it. Your register files carry no bed, no room, no capacity and no cost data — there is nothing in them that could produce a utilisation number. If someone shows you one, ask which column it came from.

× **“A friend's introduction makes a sticky customer.”**

No. First-timers brought in by an existing customer return at 66.3%; solo walk-ins at 63.9%. That difference is noise. The social effect that matters is between established regulars, not at the introduction. And two first-timers arriving *together* actually stick around less than one arriving alone — those are event tans.

× **“The faster a first-timer comes back, the better the customer.”**

No. Once someone returns at all, how quickly they did it tells you nothing about what they will spend. Week one decides *whether* (№ 5) — not how much.

× **“Seeing the same staff member builds loyalty.”**

No measurable effect at all. Customers who always saw the same person came back no more often than customers who saw somebody different every time. Which staffer is on the floor for the *first* visit matters enormously (№ 4). Continuity after that doesn't.

× **“Members sneak free tans between packages.”**

The opposite. Only 5.8% of a multi-cycle member's visits fall in an uncovered gap, and 41% of those carry a paid transaction averaging \$35. Gap visits are some of the best-paying sessions you sell. Nothing to plug.

× **“Gift certificates bring in new customers.”**

Thirteen gift-certificate payments in four years. Twenty-five coupon redemptions. There is no channel here — which is worth knowing *before* someone proposes building one.

× **“First-timers turn up on the weak morning shift.”**

No. Only 3.3% of first visits happen before 11am. There is no schedule to fix.

× **“A crowded floor kills the lotion sale.”**

Slightly true, honestly tiny. Attach does slide from 6.5% when someone's alone to 5.2% in your busiest hours — and fixing all of it is worth under \$1,000 a year *across all four salons*. Keep it as a management observation. Never monetise it.

× **“Customers with a fixed routine hour are the loyal ones.”**

If anything the reverse — the rigid-schedule customers proved slightly more fragile. Flexibility, not routine, marks the ones who stay.

× **“Letting members downshift to a cheaper plan keeps them longer.”**

Probably, but not provably — so it is not a finding. Downgraders did buy more total months than plan-stayers, but the result sits just the wrong side of significance and about a quarter of the “downgrades” are really a \$0 package or the same plan renamed. We would rather leave a plausible idea out than put a soft one in front of you.

Prepared from the four salons’ own point-of-sale records: 194,672 visits, 53,839 register transactions, 11,411 customers who ever visited, 13,225 memberships, January 2016 – March 2020, \$2,088,612 through the register. Salons de-identified as A–D. Every figure was recomputed independently by a second pass instructed to *disprove* the first; where the two disagreed, the disproof won, and where a claim could not survive that, it is not in this document — several of them are named above. Cohorts, denominators and observation windows are stated inside every “Show me the numbers” block. Nothing here was estimated, benchmarked or imported: if it isn’t in your registers, it isn’t on this page.